Reading Comprehension: Non-Fiction

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Homework Worksheet**

Worked Example

Persuasive Techniques: Extract: 'Don't just take our word for it — 9 out of 10 customers agree this is the best cereal on the market!' Identify two persuasive techniques used here.

Answer: Statistics ('9 out of 10 customers') and bandwagon appeal (suggesting most people already agree, so the reader should too).

Retrieval & Fact vs Opinion (15 questions)

1. Extract: 'Mount Everest is the highest mountain above sea level on Earth, reaching 8,849 metres. It lies on the border between Nepal and China.' According to the extract, how high is Mount Everest?
2. In the Everest extract, between which two countries does Everest's border lie?
3. Which sentence below would be a FACT rather than an opinion? A) 'Mount Everest reaches 8,849 metres.' B) 'Everest is the most beautiful mountain in the world.' C) 'Climbing Everest is pointless.' D) 'Everest is overrated.' E) 'Nepal is the best country to visit.'
4. Extract: 'Plastic bags can take up to 500 years to decompose. Many countries have introduced a small charge for plastic bags, which, frankly, should have happened decades ago.' According to the extract, how long can plastic bags take to decompose?
5. In the plastic bag extract, what have many countries introduced regarding plastic bags?
6. In the plastic bag extract, which word or phrase signals an opinion? A) 'frankly' B) 'plastic bags' C) '500 years' D) 'many countries' E) 'a small charge'
7. Extract: 'Octopuses have three hearts and eight arms lined with suckers. They are considered one of the most intelligent invertebrates, able to solve simple puzzles and open jars.' According to the extract, how many hearts does an octopus have?
8. In the octopus extract, what can octopuses do that shows their intelligence?
9. Select ALL that apply, based on the octopus extract: which statements are FACTS stated in the extract? A) Octopuses have three hearts. B) Octopuses have eight arms. C) Octopuses are the cleverest animal on Earth. D) Octopuses can open jars. E) Octopuses are better than dolphins.
10. Extract: 'The Sahara Desert covers approximately 9.2 million square kilometres, making it the largest hot desert in the world. Temperatures there can exceed 45°C during the day.' According to the extract, how large is the Sahara Desert?
11. In the Sahara extract, what temperature can the Sahara exceed during the day?
12. Which of the following, if added to the Sahara extract, would be an OPINION? A) 'The Sahara is the most boring place to visit.' B) 'The Sahara covers 9.2 million square kilometres.' C) 'Temperatures can exceed 45°C.' D) 'It is the largest hot desert in the world.' E) 'The desert is located in Africa.'
13. Extract: 'Health guidelines suggest that recreational screen time should be limited for children, as excessive use has been linked to poorer sleep and reduced physical activity.' According to the extract, what has excessive screen time been linked to?
14. In the screen time extract, what do health guidelines suggest about children's recreational screen time?
15. Is the statement 'excessive screen time has been linked to poorer sleep' a fact or an opinion, as it is presented in the extract? A) A fact, since it is presented as a finding from health guidelines/research B) An opinion, since

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it is just a feeling C) Neither — it is a question D) A fact, but only because it mentions children E) An opinion, because it mentions sleep

Purpose, Audience & Main Idea (15 questions)

1. Extract: 'Tired of New Year's resolutions that fail by February? Join FitZone today and get your first month absolutely FREE. Real results, real fast.' What is the main purpose of this extract?
2. Who is the gym extract most likely aimed at? A) Adults considering getting fitter B) Young children C) Professional athletes only D) People who dislike exercise and never will try it E) History teachers
3. Describe the tone of the gym extract.
4. Extract: 'Tomorrow will be mostly cloudy with a high of 14°C. Light rain is expected in the afternoon, clearing by evening.' What is the main purpose of this extract?
5. Describe the tone of the weather extract.
6. What is the main idea of the weather extract? A) It gives a summary of tomorrow's expected weather B) It argues that rain is dangerous C) It persuades readers to carry umbrellas D) It describes yesterday's weather E) It gives a long-term climate forecast
7. Extract: 'Some educators argue that starting school later would help teenagers, who naturally wake later, concentrate better. Others point out that later starts would disrupt family routines and after-school activities.' What is the main purpose of this extract?
8. What is the tone of the school start times extract? A) Balanced and even-handed B) Furiously one-sided C) Sarcastic D) Purely celebratory E) Panicked
9. What is the main idea of the school start times extract?
10. Extract: 'Right now, a rhino is killed every few hours for its horn. Your support can help fund rangers who protect these magnificent animals. Act now, before it's too late.' What is the main purpose of this extract?
11. Who is the rhino extract most likely aimed at?
12. Select ALL that apply, based on the rhino extract: which techniques are used to achieve its purpose? A) An urgent call to action ('Act now, before it's too late') B) Direct address to the reader ('Your support') C) An emotive description ('magnificent animals') D) A detailed scientific diagram E) A joke about rhinos
13. Extract: 'When the alarm sounds, stop what you are doing immediately. Leave your belongings behind and walk calmly to the nearest marked exit, following your teacher's instructions.' What is the main purpose of this extract?
14. Describe the tone of the fire drill extract.
15. What text structure does the fire drill extract mainly use? A) Sequential/chronological instructions B) A balanced discussion of two views C) A persuasive advertisement D) A personal diary entry E) A comparison of two products

Standard / Advanced (15 questions)

1. An advert says 'Join the millions who already trust us.' Which persuasive technique is this? A) Bandwagon appeal — suggesting the reader should follow what many others already do B) A statistic with precise data C) A direct quotation from an expert D) An example of alliteration E) A balanced counter-argument
2. A charity leaflet states 'Just £2 could save a life.' What technique makes the donation seem small, and what effect is this meant to have on the reader?
3. A headline reads 'Scientists SHOCKED by this discovery!' What technique is used in the word 'SHOCKED', and what is it trying to make the reader feel?

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4. An advert asks, 'Wouldn't you rather be safe than sorry?' What technique is this question, and what choice is the reader subtly being pushed towards?

5. A travel brochure says 'Discover paradise — before everyone else does.' What technique creates urgency here, and what fear is it playing on?

6. Extract: 'Plastic straws take hundreds of years to break down, yet we use them for minutes before throwing them away. Isn't it time we asked ourselves what kind of world we are leaving behind? Join thousands of schools already going straw-free.' Identify the rhetorical question used in this extract.

7. In the straws extract, what persuasive technique is shown by the phrase 'Join thousands of schools already going straw-free'? A) Bandwagon appeal, suggesting the reader should join because many others already have B) A statistic proving an environmental law C) A direct quotation from a scientist D) An example of alliteration E) A comparison with a rival company

8. In the straws extract, explain how the contrast between 'hundreds of years to break down' and 'minutes before throwing them away' is used to persuade the reader.

9. Extract: 'This revolutionary skincare cream has been clinically proven to reduce fine lines by 40% in just four weeks. Thousands of satisfied customers can't be wrong — isn't it time you saw the difference for yourself?' Identify the statistic used in this extract.

10. Select ALL that apply, based on the skincare extract: which persuasive techniques are used? A) A statistic ('40% in just four weeks') B) Bandwagon appeal ('Thousands of satisfied customers') C) A rhetorical question ('isn't it time you saw the difference for yourself?') D) A direct quotation from a dermatologist E) An example of onomatopoeia

11. The skincare extract uses the phrase 'can't be wrong' about thousands of customers. What is potentially misleading about using popularity as evidence that a product works? A) A large number of people liking something does not prove scientifically that it is effective — popularity is not the same as proof B) It is always 100% reliable scientific evidence C) It has nothing to do with persuasion D) It proves the product is the cheapest available E) It guarantees the product has no side effects

12. Extract: 'Our rivers are drowning in litter. Every minute, another plastic bottle is dumped into our waterways, poisoning fish, birds and the water we all depend on. We can't afford to look away any longer.' Identify an example of emotive language in this extract.

13. In the rivers extract, explain how the phrase 'the water we all depend on' is used to make the issue feel personally relevant to every reader, not just environmentalists.

14. Extract: 'Why settle for ordinary when extraordinary costs the same? Our premium broadband is faster, more reliable and cheaper than the leading competitor — numbers don't lie.' Identify the rule of three used in this extract.

15. The broadband extract states 'numbers don't lie' but gives no actual numbers or sources. What should a careful reader notice about this claim? A) It sounds convincing but provides no real evidence to support it, which is a common persuasive trick B) It is a scientifically verified fact because it mentions numbers C) It proves the broadband is definitely the cheapest available D) It is a neutral, unbiased statement E) It is a direct quotation from an independent review

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